

Workshop Agenda

Save the Blue Five | Santa Cruz, Galápagos | June 8-12, 2026

Arrival

Santa Cruz, Galápagos, Ecuador

June 8, 2026

- Upon arrival at Baltra Airport: Galápagos arrival procedures. Please have your Certificado de Transeúnte ready for airport arrival controls.
- After luggage collection: Transfer from Baltra to Puerto Ayora. The route includes the Lobitos bus to the Itabaca Channel, the ferry crossing to Santa Cruz Island, and onward transport toward Puerto Ayora. Conservation International will coordinate transport from the Santa Cruz dock toward Puerto Ayora. Final meeting points, contacts, and hotel assignments will be shared separately. The full transfer from Baltra to Puerto Ayora usually takes approximately 1.5 to 2 hours.
- Hotel check-in: Hotel check-in in Puerto Ayora. Please check your email for your assigned hotel and specific check-in instructions.
- 7:30 - 9:00 pm: Dinner and workshop objectives. Location: Bahía Mar Restaurant, Puerto Ayora.

Day 1 - Scientific Progress and Modeling Integration

Tuesday, June 9, 2026

Objective

Review the scientific and modeling progress made since the 2025 workshop, identify what is ready to move forward, clarify the most important gaps and uncertainties, and gather targeted feedback to help strengthen the work over the next year.

Session 1: Welcome and framing of progress since 2025

09.00 - 10.30

- Welcome from Charles Darwin Foundation. Rakan Zahawi or María José Barragán. Brief welcome to Galápagos and the hosting facility.
- Opening remarks. Isaac Brito-Morales and Lee Hannah. Brief welcome and overview of the workshop goals and expected outcomes.
- Participant introductions. Short introductions to align expertise across participants and ongoing contributions to the project.
- Overview of progress since the 2025 workshop.

- Key achievements. Summary of major milestones reached across data, modeling, and coordination efforts.
- Current status of the project. Where we stand today across workstreams and collaborations.
- Goals for Day 1. Build a shared understanding of the progress made since the 2025 workshop, identify the most important scientific and technical gaps, and generate focused feedback to strengthen the work over the coming year.
- Goals for the workshop. Strengthen the scientific foundation of the project while helping ensure that its outputs are relevant, actionable, and useful for regional coordination, conservation planning, and policy-oriented decision-making.

Coffee break: 10.30 - 11.00

Session 2: Scientific and modeling advances since 2025

11.00 - 13.00

This session presents key advances in climate vulnerability assessment, physical modeling, biological datasets, and species distribution modeling across the project. Together, these components help define both what has already been achieved and where focused improvements are needed to strengthen the next phase of work.

As you listen, please note which findings seem most useful for conservation planning, regional coordination, or policy-relevant decision-making, and what additional information would make these outputs more actionable. These reflections will help inform the breakout discussions later in the workshop.

- Climate change vulnerability assessment. Lee Hannah, presented by Sarayu Ramnath. Overview of the assessment framework, datasets, and initial results across taxa.
- Physical modeling and downscaling framework. Isaac Brito-Morales, including outcomes from Toulouse 2025. Summary of oceanographic datasets, downscaling approaches, and integration with biological data. Related workflow materials are available in the CESM Large Ensemble ocean downscaling repository and the Ocean downscaling viewer Shiny app.
- Status of biological data for species distribution modeling (SDMs). Isaac Brito-Morales. Current state of compiled datasets, data gaps, and readiness for modeling. Related resources are the Data repository and the Megafauna data viewer Shiny app.
- Species modeling updates. These updates present preliminary to intermediate results and are intended to guide the next phase of model improvement. Given the project timeline, the goal is to identify the most important and realistic improvements needed to strengthen the final outputs. Participants are encouraged to focus feedback on what is most important to improve over the next year. Dolphins: Mario Pardo and Ariadna Juarez. Mesopelagic systems: Yulia Egorova. First generation of SDMs: Isaac Brito-Morales.

Lunch break: 13.00 - 14.30

Session 3: Synthesis across taxa and systems

14.30 - 16.00

This session integrates insights across species, models, and environmental drivers to build a regional perspective. It will begin with a brief synthesis of key patterns and emerging insights, followed by small-group discussion to reflect on what is most relevant, what remains unclear, and how these findings could be used in practice.

- Cross-taxa patterns and emerging insights.
- Key environmental drivers and habitat use.
- Integration of biological and physical processes.
- Discussion: What are we learning at the regional scale? What are the main knowledge gaps or uncertainties? Which findings seem most relevant for conservation, planning, or regional coordination?

Coffee break: 16.00 - 16.30

Session 4: Strategic discussion and next steps

16.30 - 17.00

- Priority gaps to address.
- Short-term actions and next steps.
- Alignment across teams and workstreams.
- Preparation for upcoming project milestones.

Day 2 - From Models to Decisions: Bridging Science and Regional Needs

Wednesday, June 10, 2026

Objective

Translate scientific and modeling progress into concrete next steps, aligning technical development with regional priorities and decision-making needs.

Session 5: Working Groups - Technical Development and Regional Priorities

09.00 - 12.30

This session is structured around parallel working groups, bringing together participants to focus on complementary aspects of the project and define priorities for the next phase. The breakout discussions will be facilitated by Fausto Arias and Dylan Glave.

- 09:00 - 09:30: Introduction and framing of the working groups. Fausto Arias and Dylan Glave will introduce the objectives of the working groups, explain the structure of the breakout discussions, and highlight the key questions that will guide the session.
- 09:30 - 10:45: Parallel working groups. Technical group: modeling development, climate scenarios, data integration, and defining what is realistically achievable in the next phase of the project. Stakeholder Engagement and Regional Priorities group: regional needs, policy relevance, expected outputs, and how results can support decision-making across institutions.

Coffee break: 10.45 - 11.00

Session 6: Plenary Synthesis - Aligning Technical Capacity and Regional Needs

11.00 - 12.00

- Technical group: What we can do. Feasible modeling approaches, selected climate scenarios, data readiness, and key constraints.
- Stakeholder Engagement and Regional Priorities group: What we need. Priority outputs, regional needs, and expectations from a policy and implementation perspective.
- Discussion: Where do technical capabilities meet stakeholder needs? Where are the main gaps or mismatches? What adjustments are needed to move forward effectively?

Session 7: Discussion and agreement on next steps

12.00 - 12.30

This closing discussion will be used to identify the most important actions to carry forward, align priorities across teams, and clarify short-term deliverables. Participants will contribute ideas in plenary, and priorities will be consolidated and grouped into shared themes.

- Identification of priority actions. Ideas will be collected and clustered into key themes emerging from the discussion.
- Alignment across teams and workstreams. Participants will help identify where scientific, technical, and regional priorities overlap most clearly.
- Definition of short-term deliverables. The session will aim to highlight the most immediate and broadly supported next steps.

Lunch break: 12.30 - 14.30

Afternoon social activity and networking

- 14:30 - 17:30: Outdoor activity, snorkeling or local site visit. Designed to encourage informal exchange, strengthen connections among participants, and experience the local environment.
- 19:00 - 21:00: Group dinner, location to be confirmed.

Day 3 - Applied Science, Synthesis, and Next Steps

Thursday, June 11, 2026

Objective

Bring together the main outcomes from the workshop, translate them into concrete outputs, and define a clear path forward for collaboration and regional impact.

Session 8: Synthesis of key insights and applied perspectives

09.00 - 10.30

- Focus: connect the scientific and modeling work from Day 1 with the alignment discussions from Day 2, with a focus on how these results can inform conservation and regional planning.
- Discussion topics: from modeling to application; relevance for regional planning; handling uncertainty; cross-taxa insights; regional coordination.
- Expected outcome: a shared view of how workshop results translate into applied conservation and regional priorities.

Coffee break: 10.30 - 11.00

Session 9: Defining outputs and next steps

11.00 - 12.30

- Focus: move from discussion to definition. Identify the key products coming out of the workshop and what is needed to deliver them.
- Outputs to define: scientific outputs such as papers, datasets, and modeling workflows; applied outputs such as maps, policy-relevant products, and regional inputs.
- For each output, define lead, contributors, and timeline.
- Timeline discussion: short-term 0–3 months, medium-term 3–6 months, and long-term 6–12 months.
- Guiding question: What are we actually committing to after this workshop?
- Expected outcome: clear outputs with identified leads and realistic timelines.

Lunch break: 12.30 - 14.00

Session 10: Roadmap and coordination

14.00 - 16.00

- Focus: define how the work continues beyond the workshop.
- Key points: priority actions for the next months, coordination across teams and institutions, how to maintain momentum, and how outputs connect to regional and global processes.
- Expected outcome: a simple, shared roadmap for the next phase of the project.

Final discussion and closing

16.00 - 16.30

- Final reflections.
- Confirmation of next steps.
- Closing remarks by Isaac Brito-Morales, Lee Hannah, and the CI team.
- Evening: group dinner.

Departure

Departure and travel arrangements.